



EXECUTIVE PRICING AND PACKAGING GUIDE

Pricing and Packaging Optimization Guide 2026

A decision framework for aligning customer value, commercial simplicity and profitable growth

Prepared for Canadian boards, founders, chief executives, product, finance, marketing, sales, customer success and operations leaders

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Purpose

This guide helps leadership determine how offers, packages, prices, discounts and terms should evolve. It connects customer value, segment needs, willingness to pay, competitive alternatives, cost to serve, recurring revenue quality and implementation readiness so pricing decisions create durable value rather than short-term volume.

EXECUTIVE DECISION DASHBOARD

Management View at a Glance

Pricing is a cross-functional operating system, not a sales concession. Management should change pricing only when customer evidence, unit economics and implementation capacity support the decision, and should govern exceptions so commercial flexibility does not become uncontrolled leakage.

Executive question	ROALLA view	Decision implication
Is the value metric defensible?	CONDITIONAL	Validate the customer outcome, usage pattern, cost driver and buying behaviour behind the charge.
Are packages easy to choose?	PREPARE	Remove overlap and align tiers to distinct needs, outcomes, entitlements and service levels.
Is price realization controlled?	CONDITIONAL	Measure list-to-net movement, discount causes, approvals, terms and renewal leakage.
Can the company implement change safely?	DECIDE	Test quoting, billing, contracts, communications, support and customer migration.
What should management authorize?	PURSUE	A 90-day pricing evidence, architecture and governance program.

Recommended Management Posture

Proceed through a small number of explicit decision gates. Preserve evidence as work occurs, separate discovery from implementation, and require each investment to demonstrate value, feasibility, control effectiveness and accountable ownership before scale.

EXECUTIVE DECISION MODEL

The Eight Pricing and Packaging Decision Gates

Pricing power is created by differentiated customer value, clear packaging, disciplined economics and consistent execution. Each gate asks what evidence leadership should require before changing list price, package design, discount authority or customer terms.

Stage	Gate	Required conclusion	Decision evidence
01	Value metric	Charges align to the customer value or cost driver	Outcome, usage, willingness to pay and cost to serve
02	Segmentation	Meaningful needs and economics are distinct	Behaviour, complexity, alternatives, retention and growth
03	Packaging	Tiers differentiate outcomes without confusion	Features, services, entitlements, constraints and proof
04	Price architecture	Units, list prices and corridors are coherent	Metric, floors, regions, currencies, taxes and fees
05	Economics	The model supports lifecycle contribution	Margin, implementation, support, retention and expansion
06	Commercial policy	Discounts and terms are governed	Authority, floors, give-get, renewal and indexation
07	Transition	Customer change protects trust and adoption	Cohorts, notice, migration, exceptions and support
08	Measurement	Decisions improve through evidence	Realization, mix, win-loss, discount, churn and expansion

Decision Rule

A failed hard gate moves the initiative to Prepare or Monitor. A strong narrative, senior sponsor or attractive market cannot replace missing authority, evidence, delivery capacity or operating control.

SECTION 01

Readiness Framework

Translate ambition into a shared executive view of value, evidence, capability and risk.



MANAGEMENT ASSESSMENT MODEL

Readiness Dimensions

No.	Decision area	Management evidence	Status
01	Customer value evidence	Outcomes, usage, willingness to pay, alternatives and proof	Confirmed / Developing / Gap
02	Segmentation and packaging	Needs, complexity, tiers, entitlements, services and simplicity	Confirmed / Developing / Gap
03	Price architecture	Metrics, units, list prices, corridors, regions, currency and fees	Confirmed / Developing / Gap
04	Economics and revenue quality	Margin, cost to serve, payback, retention, expansion and cash	Confirmed / Developing / Gap
05	Commercial governance	Discounts, approvals, terms, renewal, indexation and exceptions	Confirmed / Developing / Gap
06	Implementation and measurement	Systems, contracts, migration, enablement, adoption and results	Confirmed / Developing / Gap

Evidence Standard

Assessments should distinguish verified evidence from management confidence. Where evidence is incomplete, record the gap, owner, completion date and decision that depends on it.

STRATEGIC READINESS DEPENDENCIES

What Readiness Depends On

Dependency	Why it matters	Evidence management should expect
Value metric	Charges align to the customer value or cost driver	Outcome, usage, willingness to pay and cost to serve
Segmentation	Meaningful needs and economics are distinct	Behaviour, complexity, alternatives, retention and growth
Packaging	Tiers differentiate outcomes without confusion	Features, services, entitlements, constraints and proof
Price architecture	Units, list prices and corridors are coherent	Metric, floors, regions, currencies, taxes and fees
Economics	The model supports lifecycle contribution	Margin, implementation, support, retention and expansion
Commercial policy	Discounts and terms are governed	Authority, floors, give-get, renewal and indexation
Transition	Customer change protects trust and adoption	Cohorts, notice, migration, exceptions and support
Measurement	Decisions improve through evidence	Realization, mix, win-loss, discount, churn and expansion

ROALLA Interpretation

Dependencies should be evaluated as a connected system. A weakness in ownership, data, architecture, delivery or governance can change the economics and risk of an otherwise attractive initiative.

SECTION 02

Detailed Readiness Assessment

Convert executive intent into verifiable requirements, accountable evidence and clear remediation actions.



READINESS CHECKLIST

Customer Value and Package Readiness

Completion standard Mark Ready only when the supporting evidence has been verified. Assign an evidence owner to every open item.

Gate	Readiness requirement	Ready	Gap	Evidence owner
A01	The primary value metric reflects how customers receive benefit or create provider cost.	☐	☐	_____
A02	Priority customer segments differ in needs, buying behaviour, economics or service complexity.	☐	☐	_____
A03	Buyer, user and economic sponsor outcomes are documented with supporting customer evidence.	☐	☐	_____
A04	Research tests willingness to pay, price sensitivity and trade-offs rather than stated preference alone.	☐	☐	_____
A05	Competitive alternatives include the status quo, internal workarounds and substitute solutions.	☐	☐	_____
A06	Each package serves a defined need and creates an understandable reason to move between tiers.	☐	☐	_____
A07	Features, usage, entitlements, overages and limits are clear and operationally enforceable.	☐	☐	_____
A08	Implementation, support, success and service levels are aligned to package economics.	☐	☐	_____
A09	The offer is simple enough for customers, sellers, partners, billing and support to explain consistently.	☐	☐	_____
A10	Savings, value and performance claims are accurate, authorized and supported before publication.	☐	☐	_____

READINESS CHECKLIST CONTINUED

Commercial Economics and Execution Readiness

Completion standard Use Gap to create a dated remediation action and identify the management decision that cannot proceed.

Gate	Readiness requirement	Ready	Gap	Evidence owner
B01	List prices, target corridors and approval floors are supported by value and contribution evidence.	☐	☐	_____
B02	Cost to serve includes onboarding, infrastructure, support, success, channel and exception costs.	☐	☐	_____
B03	Discount authority is role based, time bounded and connected to approved business rationale.	☐	☐	_____
B04	Approval service levels preserve deal momentum without weakening controls or accountability.	☐	☐	_____
B05	Concessions use give-get logic such as term, volume, scope, payment timing or reference rights.	☐	☐	_____
B06	Contracts address renewal, indexation, usage, overages, termination, tax and currency consistently.	☐	☐	_____
B07	Customer transition defines cohorts, notice, grandfathering, migration support and exception expiry.	☐	☐	_____
B08	CRM, quoting, billing, finance and customer systems can represent the intended model accurately.	☐	☐	_____
B09	Management tracks price realization, mix, discount, win-loss, churn, expansion and gross margin.	☐	☐	_____
B10	A cross-functional pricing council reviews evidence, exceptions and changes on a defined cadence.	☐	☐	_____

WEIGHTED EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT

Readiness Scorecard

Dimension	Weight	Evidence standard	Score	Status
Customer value evidence	20%	Outcomes, usage, willingness to pay, alternatives and proof	___/20	Strong / Developing / Gap
Segmentation and packaging	20%	Needs, complexity, tiers, entitlements, services and simplicity	___/20	Strong / Developing / Gap
Price architecture	15%	Metrics, units, list prices, corridors, regions, currency and fees	___/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Economics and revenue quality	15%	Margin, cost to serve, payback, retention, expansion and cash	___/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Commercial governance	15%	Discounts, approvals, terms, renewal, indexation and exceptions	___/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Implementation and measurement	15%	Systems, contracts, migration, enablement, adoption and results	___/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
TOTAL	100%	Weighted executive assessment	___/100	Pursue / Prepare / Monitor

Decision Thresholds

Score	Posture	Management decision
75 to 100	PURSUE	Proceed to bounded execution subject to no hard-gate failure.
50 to 74	PREPARE	Complete a focused readiness plan before major commitment.
0 to 49	MONITOR	Resolve foundational gaps before investing further.

A single material hard-gate failure overrides the weighted score. ROALLA also applies judgment where administrative readiness is high but strategic value, adoption or commercial viability is weak.

SECTION 03

Execution and Advisory Roadmap

Move from opinion to evidence, then validate the commercial and operational consequences before authorizing broad change.



READINESS OPERATING PLAN

Recommended 90 Day Mobilization

Timing	Focus	Key activities	Management output
Days 1 to 15	Align	Confirm objectives, scope, segments, decisions, constraints and evidence request.	Approved pricing mandate
Days 16 to 35	Analyze	Assess customer value, alternatives, price realization, packages, costs and economics.	Pricing evidence base
Days 36 to 55	Design	Create target packages, metrics, corridors, policy, terms and transition options.	Target price architecture
Days 56 to 75	Validate	Test customer response, seller usability, economics, systems and compliance implications.	Validated recommendation
Days 76 to 90	Authorize	Approve launch cohorts, controls, communications, owners, measures and review cadence.	Executive implementation plan

Twelve to Twenty Four Month Path

- Quarter 1: establish customer value evidence, clean price realization data and simplify priority packages.
- Quarter 2: launch controlled cohorts with seller enablement, discount governance and complete measurement.
- Quarters 3 and 4: optimize mix, migration, renewal, channel and regional execution using observed evidence.
- Year 2: refresh value, packaging and price architecture as customer behaviour, product capability and economics evolve.

ROALLA ADVISORY MODEL

How ROALLA Can Help

ROALLA acts as the technology and commercialization advisor for pricing transformation. ROALLA connects customer value, product strategy, packaging, economics, commercial policy, technology architecture and execution so leadership can improve growth quality without creating avoidable customer or operating risk.

ROALLA workstream	Executive value
Pricing diagnostic	Establish an independent fact base across value, packages, realization, economics and governance.
Customer value and segmentation	Define outcomes, alternatives, value drivers, needs, behaviour and willingness to pay.
Package architecture	Design clear tiers, entitlements, services, limits and upgrade paths.
Economics and price design	Model metrics, corridors, margins, scenarios, retention and revenue quality.
Discount and terms governance	Create authority, give-get rules, approvals, renewal, indexation and exception controls.
Customer migration	Design cohorts, communications, support, grandfathering and exception expiry.
Systems and data readiness	Align CRM, quoting, billing, finance, contracts and decision reporting.
Ongoing pricing assurance	Monitor realization, customer response, leakage, economics and evidence-based evolution.

Recommended Initial Mandate

- Four-week pricing and packaging diagnostic.
- Verified value, package, realization, discount and cost-to-serve fact base.
- Target pricing architecture with governance, transition and technology implications.
- Executive recommendation and 90-day controlled implementation plan.

CONTROL FRAMEWORK

Key Risks and Controls

Risk	Exposure	ROALLA control
Cost-plus bias	Internal cost becomes the substitute for customer value.	Use value, alternatives, willingness to pay and economics together.
Package sprawl	Too many editions and exceptions obscure choice.	Design a limited architecture with explicit segment jobs and entitlements.
Price leakage	Net realization erodes through discounts and terms.	Set corridors, authority, evidence, expiry and management inspection.
Unclear total price	Mandatory fees or conditions appear late.	Present attainable total pricing and review customer-facing representations.
Sales resistance	Teams avoid or inconsistently explain change.	Validate, enable and equip teams with value evidence and escalation paths.
Customer shock	Poor transition damages trust or retention.	Segment cohorts, communicate early and create controlled migration options.
System constraint	Quoting or billing cannot execute the design.	Test operational architecture before launch and limit unsupported exceptions.
Measurement gap	Leadership cannot separate price from mix or volume.	Create a governed baseline and track realization by cohort and segment.

Professional Advice

Qualified legal, privacy, security, tax, accounting, employment and regulatory advisors should validate matters within their professional scope. ROALLA coordinates those inputs with technology strategy, architecture, commercialization, governance and transformation decisions.

OFFICIAL EVIDENCE BASE

Selected Official Sources

These sources support the management principles summarized in this guide. Standards, laws, guidance and organizational obligations continue to evolve and must be confirmed for the specific context before acting.

Competition Bureau Canada drip pricing. [Official source](#) — Official guidance on attainable advertised prices and mandatory fees.

Competition Bureau Canada ordinary selling price. [Official source](#) — Official guidance on reference prices, savings claims and evidence for ordinary selling prices.

Competition Bureau Canada deceptive marketing practices. [Official source](#) — Official guidance on misleading representations and the general impression created by marketing.

Competition Bureau Canada performance claims. [Official source](#) — Official guidance requiring product and service performance claims to be supported by adequate and proper testing before use.

Office of the Privacy Commissioner of Canada privacy for businesses. [Official source](#) — Current guidance for private sector privacy programs and responsible customer information practices.

Trade Commissioner Service target market research. [Official source](#) — Official guidance for screening, assessing and selecting target markets.

Advisory Disclaimer

This ROALLA guide is a strategic readiness and marketing document. It is not a certification, audit opinion, legal opinion, privacy opinion, security assurance, investment recommendation or guarantee of results. Management must validate current obligations, company facts and professional advice before making material decisions.